

The Dance School Awards: Industry Award - Dance School of the Year

Dance School of the Year Application / Nomination Questions.

Please find below 5 questions which we will need you to answer to proceed with your nomination.

Judges will consider:

- Clear, specific achievements from the past year and why they matter.
- Evidence of positive impact on students, staff, or the wider community.
- A clearly articulated ethos and set of values.
- Thoughtful support for students with different goals and pathways.
- Clear safeguarding procedures embedded in everyday practice.
- Awareness of student wellbeing and duty of care.
- Evidence of commitment to equity, diversity, and inclusion in policies, practice, and culture.
- Strong leadership and professional standards.
- A compelling overall case for why the school stands out.

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Jiji Emi Dance Company

1. Tell us 3 things you are you most proud of your school achieving in the last year. *

Since opening our doors in January 2026, our Select Team has made an incredible impact in their very first competitive season. We attended our first competition together at Starpower International in Birmingham, where our dancers achieved outstanding success.

Throughout the season, our team has proudly earned scholarships to both the Battle of the Seas Cruise and the World Dance Championships, recognising not only their talent but also their dedication and potential.

Beyond their achievements on stage, our dancers have consistently been praised by judges and event staff for their professionalism, sportsmanship, and positive attitude. We are incredibly proud to be building a team that values kindness, hard work, and respect just as much as success, and we can't wait to see what the future holds for each and every one of them.

2. How would you describe your school's ethos and values? *

At our school, we believe great dancers are created through great people. While we are passionate about developing strong technical performers, we place equal importance on kindness, respect, resilience and professionalism.

We strive to create an environment where every student feels seen, supported and inspired to achieve their personal best, regardless of age or ability. We encourage our dancers to celebrate each other's successes, work collaboratively and represent our school with humility and integrity both on and off the stage.

Our ethos is centred around high standards, but never at the expense of enjoyment. We want our dancers to leave every class feeling challenged, valued and proud of their progress. We believe success isn't measured solely by trophies, but by the confidence, friendships and life skills our students gain through dance.

Since opening in January 2026, this philosophy has been reflected in the way our dancers conduct themselves. They have consistently been recognised by judges and competition organisers for their professionalism, sportsmanship and positive attitude. something we are just as proud of as their competitive achievements.

3. How do you support both recreational and aspiring professional students? *

believe every dancer deserves the same level of encouragement, regardless of whether they dance for fun or aspire to pursue a professional career. Our classes are designed to help every student build confidence, technique and a genuine love for dance, while offering additional opportunities for those wishing to take their training further.

For our aspiring professionals, we provide personalised mentoring, competition opportunities, private lessons, performance experiences and workshops that go beyond technique. These include injury prevention education, dancer reflection sessions, competition hair and make-up masterclasses, audition preparation and guidance on professionalism within the industry. Our aim is to equip dancers with the skills, confidence and knowledge to succeed both on and off the stage.

Above all, we celebrate every individual's journey and define success by personal growth as much as achievements.

4. What does safe guarding and student wellbeing look like in practice at your school? *

Student wellbeing is at the heart of everything we do. We are committed to creating a safe, inclusive and supportive environment where every dancer feels respected, valued and able to thrive.

Safeguarding is embedded into our daily practice through clear policies, open communication with families and a culture where students feel comfortable speaking to trusted staff. We prioritise both physical and emotional wellbeing by incorporating injury prevention education, encouraging healthy training habits and ensuring dancers understand the importance of rest and recovery.

We also hold regular dancer reflection sessions, giving students the opportunity to celebrate progress, set goals and discuss any challenges they may be facing. We believe this encourages resilience, self-awareness and confidence while ensuring every dancer feels heard. Our focus is not only on producing exceptional performers, but on developing happy, healthy and confident young people who can carry these values beyond the studio.

5. Why do you believe your school deserves this award? *

Although we have only been established since January 2026, we have built far more than a successful dance school—we have built a community. Every decision we make is centred around giving our students the highest quality training while ensuring they feel supported, valued and inspired to be the best versions of themselves.

In just a few months, our dancers have achieved incredible competitive success, earning scholarships to the Battle of the Seas Cruise and the World Dance Championships, while consistently being recognised for their professionalism, respect and outstanding conduct. However, our proudest achievement is the culture we have created. We celebrate effort as much as results, prioritise wellbeing alongside performance, and equip our dancers with life skills that extend far beyond the stage.

Through innovative initiatives such as injury prevention education, dancer reflection sessions and workshops covering every aspect of competitive dance, we strive to develop confident, knowledgeable and resilient performers. We are passionate about raising standards within dance education and creating an environment where every student can flourish.

Receiving Dance School of the Year would not only recognise the success of our first season but also the values, dedication and genuine care that underpin everything we do. We believe our impact is measured not only by medals and trophies, but by the confident, respectful and ambitious young people who walk through our doors every week.

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